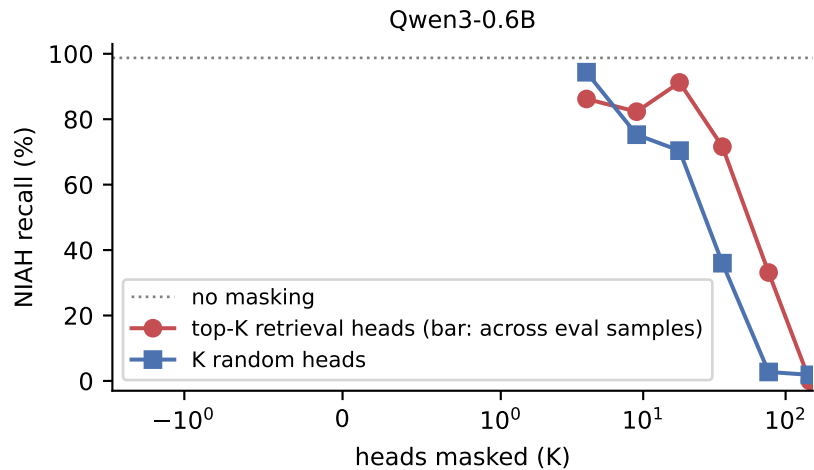
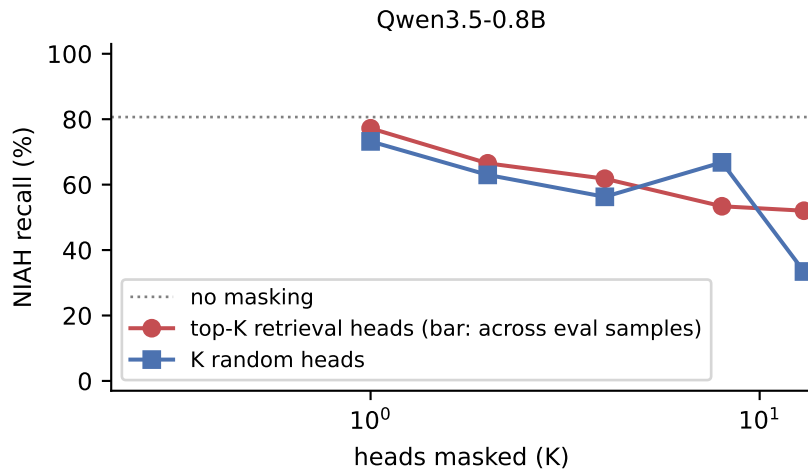


Needle-in-a-Haystack after masking top-K retrieval heads vs K random heads



Qwen3.5-0.8B: requested K=[1, 2, 4, 8, 16] -> masked K_eff=[1, 2, 4, 8, 13]